



Bob's Grill School — Drone Shot List

Wharfside Manor picnic area, Monmouth Beach NJ

Bob (on camera) · Nick (shooting) · 2026-06-04 · 11 aerials · DJI Mini 4K · recreational · ★ = also grab a vertical 9:16

✓ Before you roll

- BEFORE you fly: open Aloft and check airspace authorization + active TFRs for the site — this is coastal Monmouth Beach, so confirm the airspace class (likely uncontrolled Class G near the surface, but VERIFY) and request LAANC authorization if any controlled airspace touches the area
- TRUST certificate accessible on your phone (Nick is recreational/TRUST-certified) — have it ready in case anyone asks
- Charge ALL batteries the night before — the DJI Mini 4K gives ~30 min total across the pack; plan and storyboard every shot on the ground so you're not improvising in the air and burning flight time
- WIND IS THE ENEMY of a sub-250g drone: the Mini 4K is light and gets pushed around — smooth aerials need calm-ish air. IRONY/IMPORTANT: Ep 5 is the windy-day episode, but a windy day is BAD for the drone. Shoot the Ep 5 'wind on the water' aerial on a separate CALMER pass (the whitecaps/flags can still read on a moderate day) and avoid filming aerials during the actual gusty ground shoot
- Maintain visual line of sight with the drone at all times — no flying it behind the building or out of sight over the river
- DO NOT fly over people or residents — only launch/shoot when the picnic area and shoreline are CLEAR of people (early morning or a quiet weekday is ideal); keep the orbit-around-Bob shots with ONLY Bob in the scene
- Don't fly low over open water you can't recover from — keep enough altitude/margin that a gust or RTH still brings it back over land; respect the river
- Shoot in 4K and hold each move 2–3 seconds longer than feels natural — extra handle/hold time gives the editor room to trim, speed-ramp, and pull both 16:9 and 9:16 frames

- Golden hour (early AM or the hour before sunset) is the look — calmest wind AND best light usually line up at dawn; favor it for the beauty/establisher/end-card plates

🔥 Shooting order

Treat the drone as its own mini-mission on a CALM, golden-hour pass — ideally a separate session from the ground shoot so you're not splitting attention or burning batteries while Bob waits. Two ~30-min battery sessions: Session 1 (dawn, calmest) = establishers, rise-and-reveal hero, top-downs, beauty/end-card plates over an empty picnic area before anyone arrives. Session 2 (Bob present, area still clear of other people) = the 360° orbit around Bob cooking and the low water flyover. Capture the Ep 5 'wind on water' aerial opportunistically on any moderately breezy-but-flyable day — NOT during the actual gusty ground shoot. Always confirm Aloft is green and the area is clear of people before each launch.

BLOCK D1 — Establishers & reveals

3 shots

☐ D-1 Ep 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 HOVER/ESTABLISH 15s

FRAME High wide of the entire Wharfside waterfront — picnic area, the row of grills, picnic tables, and the river/bay beyond

DO Hold a high, steady hover for a clean establishing plate; very slow drift only

⚠️ **calm-ish wind; picnic area clear of people; golden hour preferred**

☐ D-2 Ep 1 REVEAL 14s

FRAME Start LOW and tight on Bob at the grill, then climb and pull back to reveal the river behind him

DO Begin near ground level framing Bob + grill, then a smooth simultaneous rise + pull-back that unveils the whole waterfront — the hero opener

⚠️ **calm wind; ONLY Bob in frame (area clear of residents); golden hour**

**D-3**

Ep 5

PULL-BACK

12s

FRAME Mid on the grill + water, pulling straight back and up to a wide of the breezy waterfront

DO Slow continuous pull-back/rise opening the scene out to the river — alt establisher with the water as the star for Ep 5's open

⚠️ **flyable wind only (moderate, not gusty); area clear of people**

BLOCK D2 — Top-downs

2 shots

**D-4**

Ep 1, 3

TOP-DOWN

12s

★ VERTICAL 9:16

FRAME Directly overhead of the full row of 11 grills + the new picnic tables, graphic and geometric

DO Straight-down hover, slow lateral track along the row of grills/tables

⚠️ **calm wind; area clear of people; mark a 9:16 grab for Shorts headers**

**D-5**

Ep 2

TOP-DOWN

10s

★ VERTICAL 9:16

FRAME Tight straight-down over ONE grill with the coals lit/gray

DO Centered top-down hover over a single firebox of glowing gray coals — cuts to the 'it's ready' beat

⚠️ **calm wind; coordinate with FIRE 1 gray-ready window; keep the drone high enough that downwash doesn't disturb ash — hold a safe altitude**

BLOCK D3 — Orbits & moving hero

3 shots



D-6

Ep 1, 3

ORBIT

18s

FRAME Slow 360° orbit around Bob cooking at the grill, water rotating through the background

DO Smooth full circle (or 270°) keeping Bob + grill centered — the signature hero move; water/picnic area sweep behind

⚠️ **calm wind; ONLY Bob in scene (no residents in frame); golden hour**



D-7

Ep 3, 5

FLYOVER

12s

FRAME Low flyover skimming ALONG the water line, flying toward the picnic area/grills

DO Steady low-altitude track over the river surface approaching the shore and grills — energetic transition shot

⚠️ **calm-ish wind; keep recoverable margin over water — do NOT fly low over water you can't recover from; area clear of people**



D-8

Ep 2, 3

PUSH-IN

10s

FRAME Slow push-in from a wide of the waterfront toward Bob + the grill

DO Gentle forward dolly-in that settles on the cooking action — good for mid-episode re-establish

⚠️ **calm wind; ONLY Bob in frame; golden hour preferred**

BLOCK D4 — Wind context (Ep 5)

1 shots



D-9

Ep 5

TRACK

12s

FRAME Aerial over the river showing whitecaps, ripples, and any flags/wind signs on the water and shore

DO Slow lateral track across the textured, wind-blown water — sells the 'beat the wind' premise from above

⚠ **MODERATE breezy-but-flyable day ONLY — NOT the gusty ground-shoot day; whitecaps must read; keep extra altitude margin for wind; area clear of people**

BLOCK D5 — Beauty & end-card backdrops

2 shots



D-10

Ep 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

HOVER/ESTABLISH

15s

FRAME Golden-hour beauty plate over the river/bay — warm low sun on the water

DO Near-static high hover with the faintest drift; pure ambiance for end-card backdrops and intros

⚠ **golden hour (dawn or dusk); calmest wind; area clear of people**



D-11

Ep 1, 2, 3, 4, 5

PULL-BACK

16s

FRAME High pull-back HOLD over the picnic area + water, composed to leave clean space for the 'More at picnic.vistter.com' end-card text

DO Slow pull-back that settles into a long static hold — extra hold time so the end-card overlay sits comfortably

⚠ **calm wind; golden hour; area clear of people; HOLD long for the end-card text overlay**